Unit 40 - Computer Game Platforms and Technologies
Assignment 6 - Game Concept Pitch

Introduction

Scenario / Vocational Context - *Now that you have a clearer understanding of potential stakeholders and investors for your game, you need to record a presentation to post online and send to interested parties. Your presentation should be in the following format:*

- *A video or audio recording of you as you present your high-concept document and then your game concept presentation. This can be audio or video recording of you delivering your concept and must logically accompany your documentation.*

- *Your presentation of your game concept should be by talking through both your high-concept and game concept presentation. You must talk in a clear and professional manner, showing technical understanding and terminology. It MUST be you who is presenting.*

Task 1

(U40:P4/M4/D4) - Present a game concept to stakeholders to near professional standards and consistently using subject terminology correctly

Presentation script

Introduction slide

- **Image of concept art including game title, USP and one line sales pitch**

Hello and welcome to the presentation about my video game concept called “The Untold of Coruscant”. For this pitch, I will be explaining my very own game idea in detail, also on why I thought this game concept provides a good opportunity for investment.

Market Overview slide

Firstly, is the market research overview. Basically, this is what the target market would be for the video game, and I will be explaining briefly why I have chosen these specific aspects.

- **PC, Xbox One and Playstation 4 systems**

Firstly, the game will be designed and developed for the PC, PlayStation 4 and Xbox One systems, due to the hardware requirements of a game of this calibre. Since the game is going to have an open 3D world on release. Also with the full release using a modern engine called the Unreal Engine 4.

Also, these platforms offer a much wider variety of input and output devices, that can be used for a more immersive experience, such as virtual reality, or for a specialist purpose for those found with disabilities.

- **Game Market**

While, with the genres, Untold of Coursant will focus on the causal, crime and story based market. So, what does all of this mean?

  - **Casual Games**

Well, casual essentially means a type of game where the player will sit back and relax while playing the game, meaning that it isn't extremely difficult and doesn't have a steep learning curve. The audience for this market find it interesting because some people may not like the difficult games, because it may be too frustrating or may consume too much time in order to learn them. Meaning the people in this market are looking for a game that they can essentially play in their free time, without worrying about learning how to overcome the difficulty of the game and not get annoyed doing so.

  - **Crime Games**

The crime aspect just means a game that will be focused on the life of criminals, essentially portraying the story of the anti-heroes in the game. The audience for this type of market might find crime games interesting since it gives them thrilling and emotional gameplay, which may be very desirable for a lot of people within the video game market due to the popularity of these games. Usually, the people in this market are looking for a game which shows an illegal lifestyle, usually containing weapon violence, narcotics usage and explicit language/behaviour.

  - **Story Based Games**

While the story based genre just means a game which heavily emphasises on the story aspect of the game, usually more than the gameplay aspect. This is interesting to the audience of this market because it gives them a storyline which they can get immersed into, as a form of escapism or to feed their curiosity, which is very desirable for a lot of people since games with lores are very popular amongst the gaming community. The people in this market are usually

looking for a game with a very in depth and well written story, for them to get immersed into. Meaning that the way in which the story is written and the overall quality is important.

So, with this market research of video games in mind. What inspired me to create this game in the first place...

Market Opportunity slide

...is essentially, the opportunity that the market gives to this type of video game.

- **Similar games proven successful**

Since this game is somewhat equal paradigms to that of well known open world games, such as Rockstar and 2K Games titles, because It has open world aspects, contains a story and can fall under the genre of action games and crime story games.

With the most successful being Rockstar's Grand Theft Auto franchise, especially their newest release: Grand Theft Auto 5. Meaning that it has potential since multiple games of this genre similar to this game concept, are currently succeeding in the market.

- **The release of new Star Wars movies**

With the release of newer Star Wars movies, it increases both the fan base and the demand on newer star wars games. Even then, the Star Wars was always a very popular franchise and has had a very large fan base since the release of the first Star Wars movie by LucasFilm. With this colossal fanbase, it comes without surprise that there have been a great quantity of games both released and still demanded with the beloved Star Wars theme.

- **Market for Star Wars games growing**

Meaning that the market is still growing even though there are Star Wars games which are still considered one of the best by the populus. Such as Star Wars The old republic, the original Star Wars Battlefront 1 and 2, Star Wars The Force Unleashed and Star Wars Knights of the Old Republic.

They are becoming very outdated however, meaning that there hasn't been many recent releases that have been successful, which increases the demand from the fanbase. In turn causing the market for Star Wars games to grow significantly. Especially ones that have never been done in an open world genre. Meaning that Untold of Coursant, if done successfully, could be a successful concept in the modern market.

- **Newer Star Wars games on high demand**

Also, there has been issues with the release of newer Star Wars games, such as the most recent Star Wars game, Battlefront 2 by Dice. Which suffered controversial reviews from the public due to the publisher (Electronic Arts) for charging a lot of money for the game and additional content, making the game fail to meet targets.

Meaning that the lack of success from recent Star Wars games being released and the popularity and demand increasing, due to new movies being released for the Star Wars franchise by the Walt Disney corporation, the Star Wars gaming market is desperate to receive a new Star Wars game that can both deliver fantastic visual graphics and gameplay.

So, after the realisation I had with the market opportunity, I went to design my video game idea...

Game Overview slide

...which led me to the Untold of Coursant game concept.

- **Single Player**

Firstly, Untold of Coursant will be a single player only game. Meaning, on release, it won't feature cooperative play with friends or an online competitive player vs player style. The reason for this is due to the extensive development and extra investment needed in order to create this to an optimal level, let alone a satisfactory one. However, an online multiplayer system will be considered depending on the game's overall success upon release.

- **Story Based**

The game will also contain a very heavy emphasis on the story. Meaning that it would be designed for the emotional and immersive lore of the game to make the world seem more alive and realistic in it's own respect. Instead of focusing on the action-esque style of other video games, which is only based on shooting other players and non-player characters.

- **Dark and Violent**

Furthermore, the story will contain very dark and violent scenes, making it either very desirable or controversial, depending on the audience.

- **Emotional Setting**

In terms of the emotional setting, the fights that take place in the game, with all the different high tech weapons available, can be graphic due to the untrained but brutal combat style of criminals and gang members found throughout the game.

- **Target Audience**

For the target audience, my game wouldn't necessarily be targeted at a specific group of people, gender or race. Instead, it would be targeted at people who enjoy playing a story based, open world action 3rd person shooter, but there are some scenes planned for the game considered to be extremely graphic. Hence the age rating of 18+ for the game.

Inspiration slide

As you can see, I took inspiration from a lot of video games and science fiction writing which i used in the production of the concept video game.

- **Star Wars franchise**

First and foremost, the most notable aspect about this game is that it is heavily inspired by the Star Wars genre. Since the game is set on a fictional Star Wars planet called Coruscant. I took the inspiration off Star Wars due to how strong the market is for video games and also the passion I have for the lore of Star Wars, and how it is still alive today.

- **Cyberpunk subgenre**

It will also feature the cyberpunk subgenre, due to the setting of the game. Essentially, cyberpunk is a subgenre of science fiction, where it is a mix of futuristic technology with mass poverty and crime. Which fits well into the genre, story and playstyle of the game.

- **Story Driven Games**

Story driven games also inspired the creation of Untold of Coursant, with games such as Metal Gear Solid and BioShock. Even though these games are completely different in concept and the type of story. What actually inspired me about those games is the quality of writing they contain, which made me realise how important a story can be for a video game.

- **Crime focused Games**

The game is also inspired by crime based games, such as Grand Theft Auto and Mafia. Which features significant amounts of crime throughout their story. The reason that these crime focused games inspired me is due to the thrill and suspense they always managed to bring to me while playing them.

- **Open world Games**

These games also gave me the inspiration for the open world genre. Which is basically an open world environment for the player to explore in. Giving the the game world a much more genuine feeling. Essentially, making it feel alive to the player and also giving the feeling of exploration and curiosity in certain players.

With this inspiration from the certain type of games, led me to come up with the concept of...

Game World & Theme slide

...the game world and the theme the game will have. Which will have a very specific theme to it, due to the specific story of the game.

- **Open World**

Firstly, the game will be open world, so it gives the player the ability to explore the world. Which is useful to have since they will still enjoy the game even when they want to take a break from the story telling aspect of the video game, or they want that sense of being in a living world without restrictions.

- **Set in the underworld of Coruscant during the Imperial era**

The game world will be set in the underworld of coursant, which is a dark place always absent from sunlight. Meaning that it will be constantly dark, with the only source of light being the street lights and neon signs around the environment. Also, since it is set during the Imperial era within the Star Wars lore, the fans of the franchise will notice some empirical aspects within the game.

- **Star Wars / Cyberpunk themed**

The game will also have a heavy emphasis on Star Wars and cyberpunk themed visuals and sounds. Making the world much more immersive with the story and overall setting of the game to the player, making it feel like it's the correct place to be with the combination of the story.

- **Visuals of poverty, crime and hardship**

Also, the theme helps in making the player feel like they are genuinely in the technologically advanced world of Star Wars, but also in a place filled with hardship, crime and poverty.

Now, with the gameworld and the theme in mind...

Gameplay Style slide

..the gameplay style would have to fit well with the said visuals.

- **Think of it as Star Wars meets Mafia/Grand Theft Auto/Saints Row**

Essentially, think of the game as a star wars theme of the Mafia, Grand Theft Auto or even Stains Row games.

- **Territorial Gang Warfare**

The reason for this is because it contains territorial gang warfare. Which basically means that sections of the map will be split up between rival gangs, just like the first two games in the Saints Row franchise. Which was what made those specific games really enjoyable for players.

- **3rd Person Shooter**

The perspective of the game will be a 3rd person view on a 3D world. The 3rd person view was picked because I felt that it would fit a game, since other games on the market also use 3rd person view. Which Also brings on a sense of familiarity and tradition to the genre of the game, and that a 3rd person view is also much easier to see the main protagonists emotions and body language, that could be considered important for a story based game.

- **Interaction with Environment**

The player can also interact with the environment. What that means is the player can access and pilot vehicles, destroy certain objects in the environment, pick up weapons for use and even access shops to purchase items and other essentials.

Of course, in order to make the gameplay worthwhile...

Characters and Story slide

...there needs to be characters and a story set in place.

- **Heavy Emotional Story Setting**

Basically, it is set in the underworld of the fictional city planet of Coursant found in the Star Wars lore, which was not seen in current era it is set in. Making the game story seem more interesting to the Star Wars fan. The story has a significant direction on the dark and gritty life of a young woman within the slums of the underworld in the city planet of Coruscant, plagued by poverty and crime.

- **One Playable Character**

This character is the main protagonist to the game and the only player controlled character, who is named Alisia. Essentially, she is a female character grown up within the slums of the underworld, making her very aggressive, assertive and unsympathetic. Which the player will assume it's due to the constant crime and killing making her desensitised.

The reason I have picked a female protagonist for a game like this is because there isn't a lot of female protagonists found in video games, especially ones with this type of genre. So, I felt by adding a female as a playable character, it would be a breath of fresh air for the players and would bring an interesting perspective for the player, which would hopefully get the game more attention.

- **NPC Interactions with the Player**

The NPCs are in the game to make it seem more alive, therefore more immersive to the Star Wars universe, featuring many different races and species found within the Star Wars lore.

The friendly NPCs will be implemented into the game as the main protagonist's friends and close ones, which will be heavily implemented within the story. While other friendly NPCs will just be used for assistance during combat, to make the combat within the game feel more alive to the player.

The hostile NPCs can come in many forms, ranging from a thug working for an organised crime group to a heavily armed Coruscant Underworld Police Officer. The type of enemies the player

may come across in the game will depend on the area the player is in, the mission that is currently active or the area of the map the player is on.

The neutral NPCs are there to make the game feel like it is alive and that the player is in a real city. However, there will be some neutral NPCs within the game that can be interacted with, to get extra side missions, mini games, blueprints for certain weapons/equipment or even as some backup help with some missions, as friendly NPCs.

- **Notable Emotional impact on Characters**

The story will feature the life of the main protagonist raised in poverty going through the struggles of a crime society, filled with hatred, not typically seen in any of the Star Wars movies or even other video games.

Essentially, while you play as this main protagonist, you notice the character's realisation due to the emotional and physical struggles caused by the brutal and relentless crimes throughout the story, causing her to break out of her psychopathic character and question everything around her.

Now that we have knowledge of the content of the game...

Unique Factors

...but what actually does make this game unique to others on the market?

- **Theme**

Well, the theme of the game, as I mentioned before is a Star Wars cyberpunk-esque game, which hasn't been done before, especially in an open world setting with a heavy implementation of a story. Which gives it a good chance of already standing out from the rest of the Star Wars games.

- **Gameplay**

Furthermore, this is also unique with the gameplay. Even though there have been 3rd person Star Wars games, there is no evidence of one with an open world setting with the ability to interact with the environment, and with a variety of non-player controlled characters.

- **Audio**

Additionally, since the Unreal Engine 4 is going to be used, the game will feature the capability of having fantastic audio quality due to the audio capabilities of the engine. Meaning that, if done correctly, could rival with the best audio found on high budget games such as EA's remaster on both Battlefront games.

- **Story**

The story in Untold of Coursant will be very unique in its own respect. Since it will be an originally written story focused on a specific place which hasn't been seen in any other video game or even movie, especially during the Imperial era within the Star Wars lore.

- **No Evidence of a Similar Game Style**

With all these now in mind, there is no current evidence that I have found any video games with the concepts of a Star Wars setting in an open 3D environment, set in the underworld of Coruscant during the era of the so called "Galactic Empire".

Now with the idea, concept and selling point of the video game in mind...

Development Goals slide

...I will be mentioning the plans and goals for the development of the game, stating why each is important.

- **Concept for Story**

The concept of the story will be the first goal in the development for the game. In which we will be using a 2D engine called GameMaker Studio 2 to develop the proof of concept for the testing of the story within a video game. The estimated budget for this concept stage will be £21,000, which will be the cost of the engine and salary of a single developer for under a year of concept creation, which is myself.

- **Concept for Gameplay**

The concept of gameplay will be the second goal in the development for the game. This will be done by using a low end 3D engine called Unity 3D, to develop the proof of concept for the testing of gameplay for the user. The estimated budget for this concept stage will be £175,000,

which will be the cost of the engine and the salary of a team of developers over a year or two of development.

- **Concept for Game World**

The concept of the game world will be the third goal in the development for the game. This will be done using the same engine, Unity 3D, in order to test the game world's features and environment along with further testing of gameplay. The estimated budget for this concept stage will also be £250,000, which would be the cost of a larger team of developers over two or three years of development.

- **Further Testing**

After the testing concept, there will be further testing for essential bug detection. This will be done with the modern engine of the Unreal Engine 4, in order to test the game for any large bugs or faults with the gameplay or game world. The estimated budget for this concept stage would be around £750,000 for the more modern engine and an even larger and experienced team over 2-3 years.

- **Full Release**

After all the concept test and bug tests, the game will be released to the public. The way this will be distributed is through retail, using compact discs, and through online game stores, such as Valve's Steam service. The estimated budget for the full game will be a rough estimate of over £1.5mil over the years of development.

Current Status slide

In the game's current status, we already have completed some of our development goals with 0 budget and minimal resources.

- **Concept Art**

For instance, the concept art has already been completed for the game's sale pitch and unique selling point, as seen in the beginning of this game pitch. Which was done at a budget of £0.

- **Game Documentation**

There is also an in depth game documentation featuring the intended format and devices, the genre, elements of gameplay, the market research, the target demographic, the overall content, the game mechanics, the backstory and the game environment. Which was also done with a budget of £0.

- **In the Progress of Story Writing**

We are currently in the progress of the story writing aspect of the game, which you would know by now that is an integral part of the video game and it's target audience. We predict that it would take us a couple of months in order to write and perfect the story, fixing over any mistakes or inconsistencies with the writing and immersion. Which will have an estimated budget of £100 to £500, depending of how long it would take to write the story.

- **Pre-Prototype**

However, even with the completion of the story, we wouldn't be done with the implementation of it within our video game. We would need to produce a pre-prototype concept for the video game, featuring a very cheap to produce game on a simple engine, essentially creating a low budget 2 dimensional game. Having a budget of £5,000, which would essentially be the development of the game on a free engine with only myself developing the pre-prototype over a couple of months.

- **Testing Proof of Story**

The reason for this low budget pre-prototype game, is to prove the concept of the story and it's writing into a video game. Testing whether it actually does translate well and if it is worth implementing into a game, in the most cost effective way possible. Having a budget of £21,000, as mentioned previously

Questions & Answers slide

- **Questions & Answers**

That was my game concept pitch for the Untold of Coursant, does anyone have any questions regarding the market, gameplay, story, characters or any other curiosities in general?

- **Thank You**

Thank you for listening and considering the investment of my product.